organizations to pump in money to support their planning and conduct their operations. Illegal drug trafficking carried out through the nexus between terrorist outfits and the transnational criminal gangs or mafia is a threat to national as well as international peace and security.

Earlier, narco-terrorism was identified as activities or methods used by drug mafia to carry out assault on anti-narcotics agencies/forces which roughly used the tactics of terrorist organizations like the use of car bombs, assassinations and kidnappings, against anti-narcotics police forces. Narco-terrorists in this context refer to individuals such as the drug lord Pablo Escobar from the Medellý´n cartel in Colombia and other members of drug cartels, mafia or other criminal organizations. But the present world scenario reveals that more and more terrorist organizations are using narcotics trafficking for the purpose of gaining revenue and for this they are developing partnerships with transnational drug cartels, mafia or other criminal organizations. The U.S. Department of State's International Narcotics Control Strategy Report documents report that there is a direct connection between traditional Colombian drug trafficking and money laundering organizations and Middle Eastern money launderers tied to Hezbollah. The Talibans even collected money from drug trafficking to facilitate their resurgence in Afghanistan.

Alongside narco-terrorism, terrorist organizations are linked with transnational criminal organizations of all kinds in carrying out illegal arms trafficking, extortion, kidnapping, prostitution and human trafficking, credit card fraud, social security and immigration fraud and identity theft, tax fraud; counterfeiting currencies, pharmaceuticals, cigarettes, alcohol, pirating videos, compact discs, tapes, and software and illegal oil trade. The unity and integrity of a state, therefore, is challenged from many corners, which is making the task of maintaining law and order a problem. When state leaders like Hugo Chavez, President of Venezuela are on the side of the drug cartels, then the problem becomes more acute. He stopped cooperating with the U.S. drug eradication efforts in 2005 and provided safe haven to the anti-American narco-terrorist groups,